

The Anxiety Workbook for Seniors Over 60 - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

Worksheet 4.1 - The GAD-7

Over the last two weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following? Score each: 0 not at all, 1 several days, 2 more than half the days, 3 nearly every day.

	Week 0	Week 3	Week 6	Week 12
1. Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge				
2. Not being able to stop or control worrying				
3. Worrying too much about different things				
4. Trouble relaxing				
5. Being so restless that it is hard to sit still				
6. Becoming easily annoyed or irritable				
7. Feeling afraid as if something awful might happen				
Total (0 to 21)				

Reading it: 0 to 4 minimal; 5 to 9 mild; 10 to 14 moderate; 15 to 21 severe. A score of 10 or more is the level at which the doctor should know and a talking therapy is recommended; do the program in either case, and take the scores to the appointment. (The GAD-7 was developed by Spitzer, Kroenke, Williams and Löwe and is free to use.)

Worksheet 4.2 - My anxiety, in my words

What I worry about most (three things)	
What my body does when I am anxious	
What I avoid because of it	
What I check, or ask others about, to feel safer	
When it is worst (time of day, place, situation)	
What I have lost to it (things I used to do)	
What I want back, by the end of the six weeks (three things)	

Worksheet 1.1 - The anxiety diary

Day, time	Situation (the facts)	Body (what, 0-100)	Thought (the exact words or image)	What I did	Then (how long; 0-100 at the end)

Worksheet 1.2 - The caffeine, alcohol and sleep audit

Day	Coffee (cups, and when)	Tea, cola, energy drinks, chocolate	Alcohol (units, and when)	Bed time / up time / hours slept	Naps	Anxiety today (0-100)
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Worksheet 1.3 - What I have stopped doing, and what I do to feel safe

Things I used to do and now avoid or do less (places, people, activities, tasks)	Since when	Things I do to feel safe (checking, asking, carrying, sitting near the door, only with someone)

Worksheet 2.1 - The daily practice log,

Week 2

Day	Breathing a.m. (mins)	Breathing p.m. (mins)	Relaxation (mins)	Walk (mins)	Caffeine (cups)	Alcohol	Slept (hours)	Anxiety today (0- 100)
Mon								
Tue								
Wed								
Thu								
Fri								
Sat								
Sun								

Worksheet 2.2 - The panic first-aid card

(cut out; wallet or handbag)

This is anxiety. It is unpleasant and it is not dangerous. It peaks and passes, usually within ten minutes.

Breathe out slowly. In for four, out for six. Shoulders down. Stay where I am.

Five things I can see. Four I can hear. Three I can touch.

Do not check the pulse, the phone or the news. Do not leave. Let it pass.

It has passed every time before. It will pass now.

Worksheet 3.1 - The worry log and worry time

Day	The worry, in one line (written when it arrives)	Real or hypothetical?	Dealt with at worry time?	Still a worry after worry time? (Y/N)

Worksheet 3.2 - Problem-solving the real ones

Step	
1. The problem, in one sentence	
2. All the possible solutions (including the silly ones)	
3. The one I choose, and why	
4. The first small step, and when (day, time)	
5. Done? What happened?	
6. Next step, or solved	

Worksheet 3.3 - The uncertainty experiments

The thing I usually do to be sure (check, ask, ring, look up)	What I will do instead this time	What I predict will happen (and how likely, 0-100%)	What actually happened	What I learned

Worksheet 4.1 - The five-question thought record

Situation (from the diary)	
The thought (exact words), and how much I believe it (0-100)	
Anxiety (0-100)	
1. Evidence for (facts only)	
1. Evidence against (facts only, including every time it did not happen)	
2. The most likely outcome, in a percentage	
3. If the worst happened: what I would do, step by step, and who would help	
4. What I would say to a friend of my age with this thought	
5. The trap	
The balanced thought (belief 0-100)	
Anxiety now (0-100)	

Worksheet 4.2 - My coping statements (three; on a card)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Examples from readers: "My heart has raced a hundred times and been checked twice; this is anxiety, and it passes." "A forgotten name is a forgotten name." "If I fall, I have the alarm, I know how to get up, and I have got up before." "I have coped with worse than this, and I coped."

Worksheet 4.3 - Probability and cost (for health worries)

The symptom	
The illness I fear	
How likely, honestly, in a person like me (ask the doctor for the number; write it)	
The innocent explanations, and how likely	
What I would do if it were true (the steps, the people, the treatment that exists)	
Checking or searching: what it did for me last time, and for how long	
The rule for this symptom (see the doctor if... ; otherwise, no checking for... days)	

Worksheet 5.1 - The ladder

Rung	The situation (specific: where, when, how long, alone or not)	Expected anxiety (0-100)	Done (dates)	Peak / end anxiety each time	What I learned
10 (hardest)					
9					
8					
7					
6					
5					
4					
3					
2					
1 (easiest)					

Worksheet 5.2 - The safety behaviours to drop

What I do to feel safe	What I fear would happen without it	The rung on which I will drop it	Dropped (date)	What happened

Worksheet 5.3 - Facing the sensations (for panic)

The sensation I fear	How to bring it on (safely; a minute)	Anxiety (0-100) first time / fifth time	What I learned
Racing heart	Walk briskly up and down the stairs, or march on the spot, for a minute		
Dizziness	Turn on the spot, slowly, for thirty seconds (holding the worktop); or shake the head gently side to side		
Breathlessness	Breathe through a straw for a minute		
Unreality, tingling	Breathe fast and shallow for a minute (not if you have heart or lung disease: ask the doctor first)		
Tension, trembling	Tense every muscle for a minute		

Worksheet 6.1 - What matters to me

Area	What matters to me here	One thing I could do this week
People (family, friends, neighbours)		
Health and the body		
Home, garden, the practical		
Learning, hobbies, interests		
Faith, meaning, nature, beauty		
Giving (helping, volunteering, the grandchildren)		

Worksheet 6.2 - The week planner

Day	Breathing / relaxation / walk (times)	Worry time	Ladder rung	One thing that matters	One contact with a person	Anxiety today (0-100)
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Worksheet 6.3 - The maintenance plan

What I will do every day (breathing; the walk; the one thing; the contact)	
What I will do every week (relaxation; worry time if needed; the planner; the review)	
My early warning signs (from the diary)	
What I will do at the first sign (which week, which worksheet)	
The situations I will keep facing so they stay easy	
Who I will tell if it slides, and what I will ask them for	
When I will see the doctor (score of 10 or more for a month; the physical symptoms change; thoughts of not wanting to be here)	
Where this book and the worksheets live	

Worksheet 6.4 - A letter to myself for a bad day

Dear _____,

When you read this, the anxiety is back, and you are frightened that it is all undone. It is not. Here is what you learned in six weeks, in your own words:

Here is what worked best: _____

Here is what to do today, first: _____

Here is who to ring: _____

And here is the thing you did in Week 5 that you thought you never could:

It passed before. It will pass now. Go and do the first small thing.

The anxiety diary

Day, time	Situation	Body (0-100)	Thought	What I did	Then

The five-question thought record

Situation	
Thought (belief 0-100) / anxiety (0-100)	
Evidence for / against	
Most likely outcome (%)	
If the worst happened: what I would do, who would help	
What I would say to a friend	
The trap	
Balanced thought (belief) / anxiety now	

The ladder

Rung	Situation	Expected (0-100)	Dates done	Peak / end	Learned
10					
9					
8					
7					
6					
5					
4					
3					
2					
1					

The twelve-week tracker

Week	Breathing (days)	Walk (days)	Relaxation (days)	Worry time (days)	Rungs climbed	Contacts	Anxiety (average 0-100)	GAD-7
0								
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								

6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								